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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)
REGULAR EXAMINATION, October 2026
Fifth Semester
Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG5DSEENG306 - WRITING FOR THE MEDIA
Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Scheme of Valuation

Part A - MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. b) organise reliable and relevant material [U] / [CO1]
2. d) Character costume design [K] / [CO2]
3. b) It is created for a different viewing context [K] / [CO3]
4. c) To guide the listener on what step to take next [U] / [CO4]
5. c) Sound and voice [K] / [CO1]
6. a) It creates a sense of realism [U] / [CO1]
7. a) Visual compression of time [U] / [CO2]
8. a) Print readers read fully; online readers only scan [U] / [CO3]
9. b) Truthfulness [K] / [CO4]
10. c) Problem-solution commercial [U] / [CO4]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B - Short Answer
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. Careful research ensures that the information presented in the podcast is accurate and meaningful. [U] / [CO1]
12. The core idea provides direction and focus - allows one to determine the audience, thus setting the style, tone and detailing. [U] / [CO2]
13. Confusing visuals distract viewers, create misunderstandings, weakens the message Conveyed - reduces audience engagement, affects comprehension, and diminishes the overall effectiveness. [U] / [CO3]
14. Informative function - informs potential consumers about products and services. [U] / [CO4]
15. Digital document life cycle refers to the stages through which a digital document passes from creation to disposal - three main stages are pre-production, production and post-production. [K] / [CO3]
16. Pauses can create tension, highlight emotion or mark transitions - silence boosts how a scene is perceived. [U] / [CO1]
17. Functions as a practical guide for the entire production team - helps coordinate the work of multiple professionals involved in filming. [U] / [CO2]
18. Any word or phrase that a user types into a search engine - using relevant keywords help content appear in suitable search results - use of effective keyword selection makes online information easier to find and access. [U] / [CO3]
19. Visually designed advertisements - combine text, images and graphics - aim to attract attention and persuade readers - characteristics include images, creative layouts, typography, strong headlines, body copy, brand logo and contact information - elements include headline, images, body copy and brand identification - work together to guide the reader towards the main message of the advertisement. [U] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C - Essay
Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Copywriting is the process of creating persuasive written messages that encourages readers to take a specific action. Process is as follows:
Begin with a clear objective - Identify target audience - Treat script as a blueprint - Use familiar situations & culture - Start with a strong hook - Use concise & purposeful storytelling - Create emotional impact - Keep the message simple & memorable - Use dialogue & visuals effectively [U] / [CO4]

21. Audio Documentary: presents factual information & uses narration, interviews, archival recordings, and actuality sounds. Narration provides context, while authentic voices and environmental sounds establish credibility and realism. Storytelling organises facts into a coherent and engaging account.
Docudrama: combines factual material with dramatic reconstruction. Narration supplies background information, dialogue recreates conversations, and sound establishes atmosphere. This format makes factual subjects emotionally engaging while requiring a distinction between documented facts and dramatized elements.
Audio Drama: fictional storytelling format created primarily through sound. It uses dialogue, character voices, sound effects, music, and silence to establish settings, develop characters, and advance the plot. Narration may introduce scenes or explain events, although some dramas rely entirely on dialogue and sound. [U] / [CO1]

22. Plot: strategic selection & arrangement of events for maximum emotional & dramatic effect.
Causality: relationship between events, in which one action produces a consequence that influences subsequent events – May be weak or strong
Conflict: the central force driving a story forward. It may be internal, interpersonal, social, or environmental.
Reversal: shifts plot direction dramatically. Types: fortune changes, new knowledge, dramatic change of location, power shift
Dramatic progression: the gradual development of tension and stakes. A screenplay typically follows an exposition, rising action, climax, and resolution.
Causality ensures coherence, conflict provides dramatic energy, reversals maintain unpredictability, and progression guides the audience towards a satisfying resolution. Successful plot construction balances surprise with plausibility. [U] / [CO2]

23. Digital media communication is an interaction of verbal, auditory, and visual elements. Text communicates information directly through captions, headlines, subtitles, scripts, and on-screen messages. In digital storytelling, text can provide context, establish themes, and guide interpretation. Sound creates a sense of space and realism, establish settings, indicate action, create suspense, and suggest events that are not visually represented. Music establishes mood and tone, connects scenes, reinforces themes, and influences audience responses. Silence or pause indicates hesitation, grief, uncertainty, or anticipation. The absence of sound can intensify emotions and draw attention to significant moments. Voice conveys information while expressing personality, emotion, authority, and cultural identity. Thus, digital media derives its narrative power from the meaningful combination of the above elements, enabling complex ideas and memorable audience experiences. [U] / [CO3]

[15x2 = 30]